

THE KINETIC CODE: OFFICIAL RULES OF CASCADE

Version 1.0 (Real-World Adaptation)

SECTION I: THE ARENA ("THE TURBINE")

1.1 Dimensions

The field is a massive square, emphasizing lateral movement and endurance.

- **Total Area:** 90 meters x 90 meters (approx. 100 yards x 100 yards).
- **Surface:** Grass or Turf (must allow for sliding/falling safely).

1.2 Zones

- **The Hub:** A center circle (10m diameter) used for the initial Launch (kickoff).
- **The Banks:** The outermost 10-meter strips running the full length of the left and right sides. These are "Safe Zones" regarding boundaries—momentum often carries players here.
- **The Socket (Scoring Zone):** A semi-circular area (radius 15m) located at the center of each team's endline.
- **The Cascade Zone:** A marked 10m x 10m square located exactly 20 meters in front of the Socket.

1.3 The Equipment

- **The Core (Ball):** A weighted medicine ball.
 - *Weight:* 3 kg (approx. 6.6 lbs).
 - *Texture:* High-grip rubber or leather texture.
 - *Logic:* Heavy enough to induce fatigue and limit long passes, light enough to run with.

SECTION II: THE ROSTER (7 vs 7)

Each team fields 7 players. Roles are visually distinguished by armband or jersey color.

2.1 The Runners (3 Players)

- *Archetype:* Speed, Agility, Stamina (The "Vif" Role).
- *Ball Privilege:* **UNRESTRICTED.** Runners may carry the Core and move freely.
- *Constraint:* Subject to the **Law of Inertia** (See Section 3). They cannot stop moving while holding the Core.

2.2 The Anchors (4 Players)

- *Archetype*: Strength, Positioning, Defense (The "Human" Role).
- *Movement*: Can move freely anywhere on the field *without* the ball.
- *Ball Privilege*: **RESTRICTED**.
 - Upon touching/catching the Core, an Anchor becomes a **"Turret."**
 - They must establish a pivot foot immediately.
 - They cannot take steps to advance the ball.
 - *Exception*: Momentum steps (1-2 steps) allowed solely to stop safely after a catch.

SECTION III: THE PHYSICS OF PLAY

3.1 The Law of Inertia (Applies to Runners)

The defining rule of Cascade.

- **Perpetual Motion**: A Runner holding the Core must maintain visible forward or lateral momentum.
- **The Static Fault**: If a Runner stops, pauses to look for a pass, or walks, the referee calls a "Static Fault."
 - *Penalty*: Immediate Turnover at the spot of the fault.

3.2 The Turret Rule (Applies to Anchors)

- An Anchor holding the Core has **5 Seconds** to release the ball (Pass or Kick).
- If they lift their pivot foot or hold the ball longer than 5 seconds -> **Static Fault**.

3.3 The Tackle (Stopping Momentum)

Defense in Cascade is about killing speed, not just bringing players to the ground.

- **Legal Tackle**: Wrapping the arms around the torso or waist.
- **The "Wrap" Call**: If a defender wraps a Runner and stops their forward momentum for **1 full second** (even if the Runner is still standing), the referee blows the whistle.
 - *Result*: Turnover (Defense wins the ball at the spot of the Wrap).
- **Strip Ball**: Defenders may attempt to strip the ball, but given the weight of the Core, this is difficult.

SECTION IV: SCORING

The objective is to deposit the Core into the opponent's **Socket**.

4.1 The Run (3 Points)

A Runner carries the Core across the threshold of the Socket.

- *Requirement*: The Runner must be in possession and in motion crossing the line.

4.2 The Throw (2 Points)

The Core is passed from outside the Socket to a teammate (Runner or Anchor) who catches it

inside the Socket.

- *Note:* Anchors are valuable here. An Anchor can run empty-handed into the Socket, plant their feet, and catch a high-point pass to score.

4.3 The Kick (1 Point)

A Drop-kick or Punt sending the Core through a specialized target/uprights at the back of the Socket.

- *Usage:* Typically used by Anchors when the defense has walled off the Socket.

4.4 The Cascade Multiplier (x2 Points)

If the scoring play (the final run, the throw, or the kick) physically passes through the **Cascade Zone** immediately prior to the score, the points are doubled.

- *Run:* 6 Points.
- *Throw:* 4 Points.
- *Kick:* 2 Points.

SECTION V: GAMEPLAY LOOP

5.1 The Launch

- Game starts with a "Launch" (Kickoff) from the Hub.
- The receiving team must catch the ball (Anchor or Runner) to begin the drive.

5.2 Movement & Passing

- **Direction:** Unlike Rugby, **Forward Passes are LEGAL**, but difficult due to the heavy ball.
- **Strategy:** Teams use Anchors as pivot points.
 1. Runner A sprints, gets tired.
 2. Passes to Anchor B (who is stationary or stops to catch).
 3. Anchor B acts as a turret, scanning the field.
 4. Runner C cuts swiftly past Anchor B to take a hand-off or short pass at full speed.

5.3 Turnover on Downs

- If the ball touches the ground (fumble or incomplete pass), it is a **Dead Ball**.
- Possession turns over to the other team at the spot where the ball touched the ground.

SECTION VI: FOULS & SAFETY

6.1 Safety Violations

- **High Tackle:** Tackling above the shoulders is a Red Card (Ejection).
- **The Spear:** Using the Core (Medicine Ball) to intentionally strike an opponent is a Red Card.

6.2 Technical Fouls

- **Deceleration:** Runner moving too slow (Referee discretion).
- **Travel:** Anchor moving feet while holding the Core.
- **Stalling:** Anchor holding ball > 5 seconds.

Game Duration: Two halves of 30 minutes. Running clock.